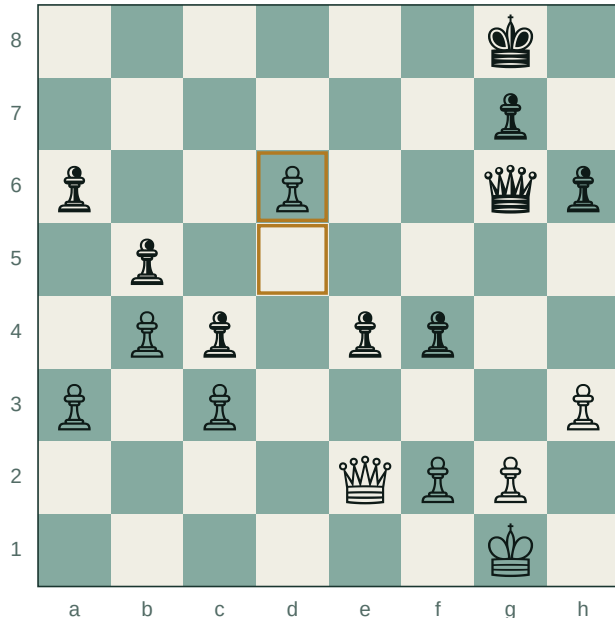


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 32

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 32.d6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

32...f3 33. Qf1 Qxd6

32...f3 The pawn moves from f4 to f3. Recorded reply: **33.Qf1**.

33...Qxd6 The queen captures the pawn on d6.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on g2.